



Student Experience

Black Georgetown Rediscovered: Students Help Preserve History at Underground Railroad Hideout

July 8, 2021

 ([/#facebook](#))  ([/#twitter](#))  ([/#email](#))

Students enrolled in the Black Georgetown Rediscovered course toured the Mount Zion – Female Union Band Society cemeteries and helped document the estimated 9,000 African American residents of Georgetown who are buried at the historic site.

Lisa Fager, executive director of the Mount Zion – Female Union Band Society cemeteries (<https://www.mtzion-fubs.org/>), led the tour. Students then entered headstone inscriptions into a database developed by Mary Beth Corrigan, curator

of the Collections on Slavery, Memory, and Reconciliation (<https://guides.library.georgetown.edu/SVR>) for the Lauinger Booth Family Center for Special Collections (<http://www.georgetown.edu>) team.

The course is part of the Summer Hilltop Immersion Program, a five-week summer program of academic, experiential learning and social activities for the Class of 2024 and newly admitted transfer students.

Taught by Andrew Davenport, a doctoral candidate studying U.S. history and a research assistant with the Georgetown Slavery Archive (<https://slaveryarchive.georgetown.edu/>), *Black Georgetown Rediscovered* examines Georgetown's forgotten – and then remembered – Black history through walking tours and the book and accompanying documentary, *Black Georgetown Remembered*.

Members of the Georgetown community were invited to participate in the tour as part of the university's celebration of Juneteenth (<https://www.georgetown.edu/juneteenth/>), a holiday that commemorates the end of the enslavement of people of African descent in the United States.

Scroll to explore more of the student experience at Mount Zion – Female Union Band Society cemeteries.



Black Georgetown Remembered (<https://www.georgetown.edu>)

Students have been reading Black Georgetown Remembered and watching the accompanying documentary, which compiles recollections from members of Georgetown's Black community, some of whom still reside in the neighborhood.



An estimated 9,000 African American residents of Georgetown are buried at the historic Mount Zion – Female Union Band Society cemeteries.

“I can’t imagine being on campus continuing my next two years at Georgetown not knowing this history here... The potential connections of slaves who helped build Georgetown are potentially buried here, so being part of that volunteer work, trying to recover that history – it’s really meaningful.”

– Hyland Brown (C’23)



Lisa Fager, executive director of the Mount Zion – Female Union Band Society cemeteries, taught students about the cemeteries’ history and current state during a guided tour.

*"I think this definitely gives us an opportunity to
(<https://www.georgetown.edu>).
understand the spaces surrounding what we're learning
about, and there's a different understanding that you get
when you have the opportunity to physically see and
experience the space... This is an opportunity for us to
directly participate in making stories known, which is so
important for all of us that are now part of the
Georgetown community."*

– Christianna Doele (SFS'24)

The brick structure is the cemetery vault, which served as a hideout on the Underground Railroad.

"It's really emotional ^(<https://www.georgetown.edu>) being here. When we were at the burial vault, knowing that was a place where enslaved people hid, there are no words to describe it, really."

– Armoni Armour (C'24)

Following the tour, students documented the inscriptions on headstones by logging them into a database via Google Forms on their phones.

"The experiential aspect of the course I think allows students to live history and to really interact with the community on a level we wouldn't get just attending Georgetown...It's given us the opportunity to be responsible stewards of the history of Georgetown University, and hopefully take action afterwards that tries to repair, in some way, the people that came before us."

– Nicholas Lohman (SFS'24)

(<https://www.georgetown.edu>).

The database was developed by Mary Beth Corrigan, curator of the Collections on Slavery, Memory, and Reconciliation for the Lauinger Booth Family Center for Special Collections, in partnership with Fager's team.

"I'm from Venezuela, which is also a colonized country. Getting the opportunity to learn about this, I also feel like I'm connecting to my own history there."

– Andrea Nucete (SFS'24)

The students' work will help populate the database to better understand who's buried at the cemeteries for preservation and future research purposes.

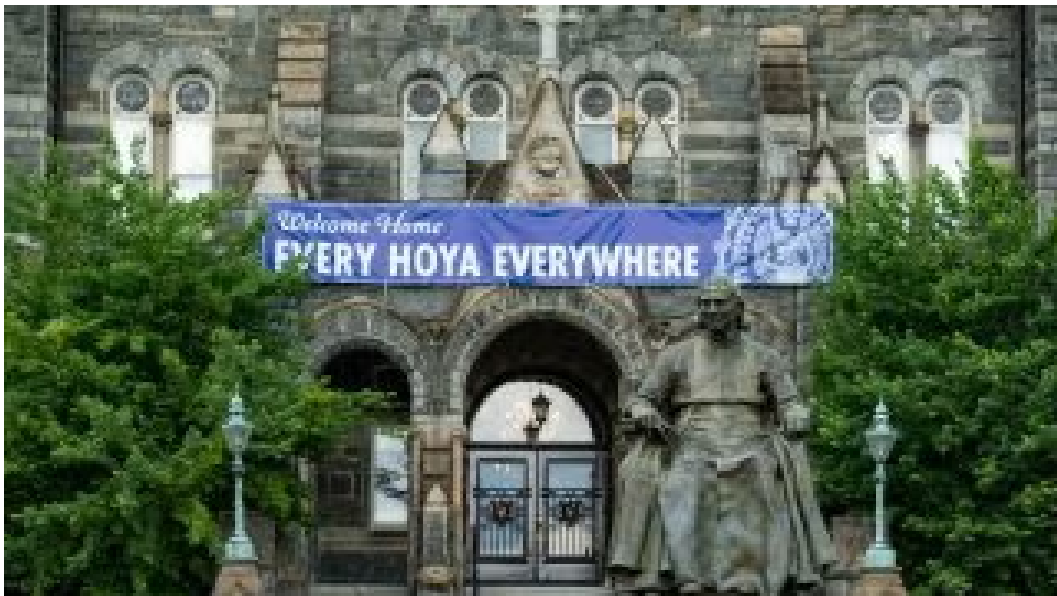
(<https://www.georgetown.edu>).

Related Content



Discovery & Impact

Georgetown Community Reflects on Slavery, Memory, and Reconciliation
(/slavery/)



Student Experience

Class of 2024, New Transfer Students Move to the Hilltop, Start First In-Person Classes (/news/class-of-2024-new-transfer-students-move-to-the-hilltop-start-first-in-person-classes/)
(<https://www.georgetown.edu>)



University News

Georgetown Honors Juneteenth, a Day To Commemorate Emancipation and the End of Slavery in the United States (/juneteenth/)



University News

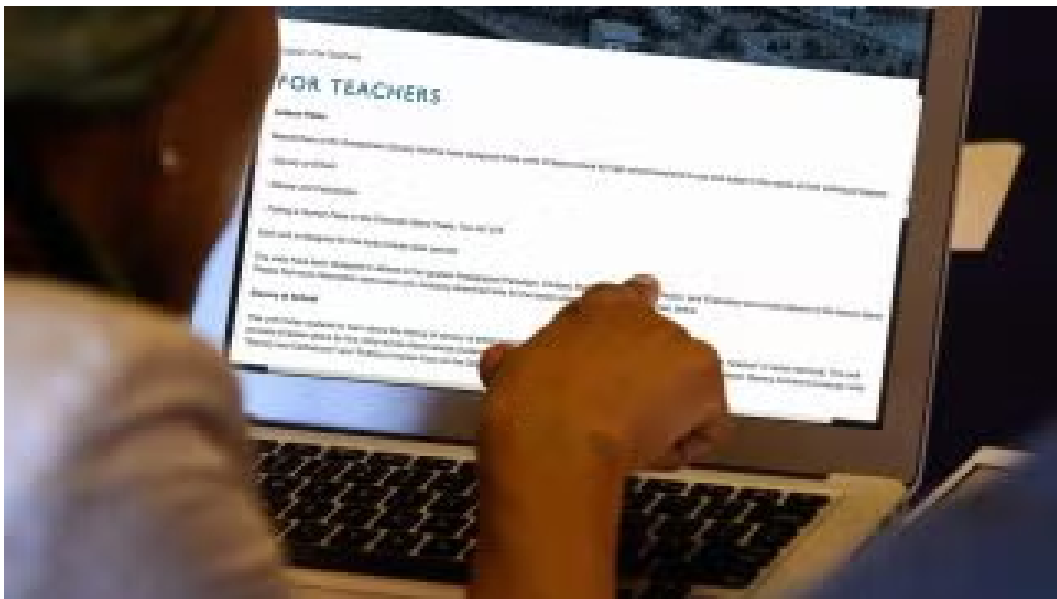
Georgetown University and Holy Trinity Complete Holy Rood Cemetery Restorations (/news/holy-rood-cemetery-to-be-restored-by-georgetown-holy-trinity-catholic-church/)

(<https://www.georgetown.edu>).



University News

Georgetown Preserves Memory, Charts Path for Lasting Change at Emancipation Day Conference on Legacies of Enslavement (/news/georgetown-preserves-memory-charts-path-for-lasting-change-at-emancipation-day-conference-on-legacies-of-enslavement/)



Discovery & Impact

Georgetown Slavery Archive Provides Educational Outreach Events, Opportunities (/news/georgetown-slavery-archive-provides-educational-outreach-events-opportunities/)

Tagged

Engaging Washington, DC

(<https://www.georgetown.edu/news/tag/engaging-washington-dc/>),
(<https://www.georgetown.edu>).

Racial Justice (<https://www.georgetown.edu/news/tag/racial-justice/>),

Slavery, Memory, and Reconciliation

(<https://www.georgetown.edu/news/tag/slavery-memory-and-reconciliation/>).

Contact Us

(<https://www.georgetown.edu/contact/>)(<https://www.georgetown.edu/about/>)

About

Directory

(<http://contact.georgetown.edu/>)

Academic Calendar

(<https://registrar.georgetown.edu/academic-calendar>)

Visit

(<https://www.georgetown.edu/plan-your-visit/>)

Careers (<https://careers.georgetown.edu/>)

Media Resources

Maps (<https://maps.georgetown.edu>)

(<https://www.georgetown.edu/media-resources/>)

Instagram (<https://www.instagram.com/georgetownuniversity/>)

LinkedIn (<https://www.linkedin.com/school/georgetown-university/>)

TikTok (<https://www.tiktok.com/@georgetownu?lang=en>)

X (<https://twitter.com/georgetown>)

Facebook (<https://www.facebook.com/georgetownuniv>)

Threads (<https://www.threads.net/@georgetownuniversity>)

YouTube (<https://www.youtube.com/georgetownuniversity>)

Georgetown University

37th and O Streets, N.W.

Washington, D.C. 20057

P. 202-687-0100 (tel:+12026870100).

(/)

Privacy Policy (<https://www.georgetown.edu/privacy-policy/>)

Copyright (<https://www.library.georgetown.edu/copyright>)
(<https://www.georgetown.edu>).

Accessibility (<https://accessibility.georgetown.edu/>)

Notice of Non-Discrimination (<https://ideaa.georgetown.edu/notice-of-non-discrimination/>)

© 2025 *Georgetown University*